Calvin Li

Seattle, WA

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github.com/calvin-li

Senior backend engineer with 5+ years optimizing high-throughput distributed systems at scale. Experienced leading offshore teams, inheriting orphaned codebases, and bridging cloud environments post-merger. Passionate about turning operational chaos into quiet, predictable systems.

Programming Languages and Technologies

Python | Google Cloud | Terraform | DevOps | Git | Datadog | Kubernetes | Kotlin | C# | AWS | Typescript

Work Experience

Zonar Systems Inc, Senior SDE, Data Services Team **09/24 - 09/26, Seattle WA**

- Improved pipeline reliability. Tuned Datadog/PagerDuty to eliminate false P1 alerts and secured cloud capacity to prevent peak backlogs in our 500M msgs/day system.
- Assumed on-call maintenance for over a dozen legacy side projects. Kept systems live and shipped required updates, often without original developers.
- Orchestrated driver association sync, streaming 5K driver asset assignments per day from GCP to AWS Kinesis via Apache Dataflow, unifying fleet visibility across clouds.

Zonar Systems Inc, Tech Lead, OCI Team **09/24 - 09/26, Remote (Vietnam)**

- Coordinated global communications and JIRA sprint planning for an 8-person overseas development team, maintaining on-time project delivery at an estimated 25% of the cost.
- Directed project a third-party integration for 10,000 dashcams recording safety events and driver associations, absorbing frequent requirement shifts to secure an on-time launch.
- Managed the certification of Zonar hardware across three CARB-CTC protocols, automating mandatory emissions checks while reducing costs by up to 80%.

Zonar Systems Inc, Tech Lead, Vietnam Support Team **09/24 - 09/25, Remote (Vietnam)**

- Led an 8-person off-hours support team providing on-call coverage and 99.9% uptime for 10 Vietnam-based contractor teams.
- Instilled a ”false positives over false negatives” incident culture on the team. Traveled onsite to coach, eliminated false negatives entirely.

Zonar Systems Inc, Senior SDE, Gateway Integrations team **03/23 - 09/24, Seattle WA**

- Diagnosed and triaged customer-facing issues during Light Duty TCU field tests and beta trials. Worked with customer care and firmware teams to root-cause issues within 8 hours.
- Led harsh event detection for LDTCU. Owned the end-to-end translation of raw sensor data into harsh acceleration/turning/braking events with minimal false positives.
- Mentored a summer intern through a successful PubSub-to-BigQuery PoC that became production infrastructure, still in use today.
- Co-organized the company-wide hackathon to foster in-person cross-team collaboration following reopening of the office.

Zonar Systems Inc, Software Engineer II, OEM team **03/20 - 03/23, Seattle WA**

- Helped plan and develop the OEM Platform, which generalized the data ingestion process and made it easier to onboard and maintain data sources
- Maintained existing OEM services and uplifted them to OEM Platform

Zume Inc, Software Engineer, Packaging **11/19 - 03/20, Seattle WA**

- Worked on web app for tracking production at packaging factory

Microsoft Corporation, Software Engineer, Microsoft Graph API **08/17 - 06/19, Redmond WA**

- Expanded service into new cloud environment (US government)
- Took ownership of our integration testing service
- Split time between feature development and maintenance of 4 nines uptime
- Part of the on-call rotation, maintained 4 nines uptime

Microsoft Corporation, Software Engineer, Azure AD Graph API **06/16 - 08/17, Redmond WA**

- Implemented publisher domain verification to Applications API for app security
- Maintained legacy SDK and improved automation for updating to new versions. Also worked with users to transition them to successor product (Microsoft Graph)

Education

University of California, Davis

Bachelor of Science Computer Science, Master of Science Computer Science

Software Engineer Intern, Microsoft Authenticator App, 6/2015 - 9/2015

- Added fingerprint authentication and Apple Watch integration, reducing time needed to authenticate by 80% without compromising security

Personal Projects

Quest

github.com/calvin-li/Quest

- Android app I made to help me track tasks using the notification system
- Source code on Github, also on the Play Store